



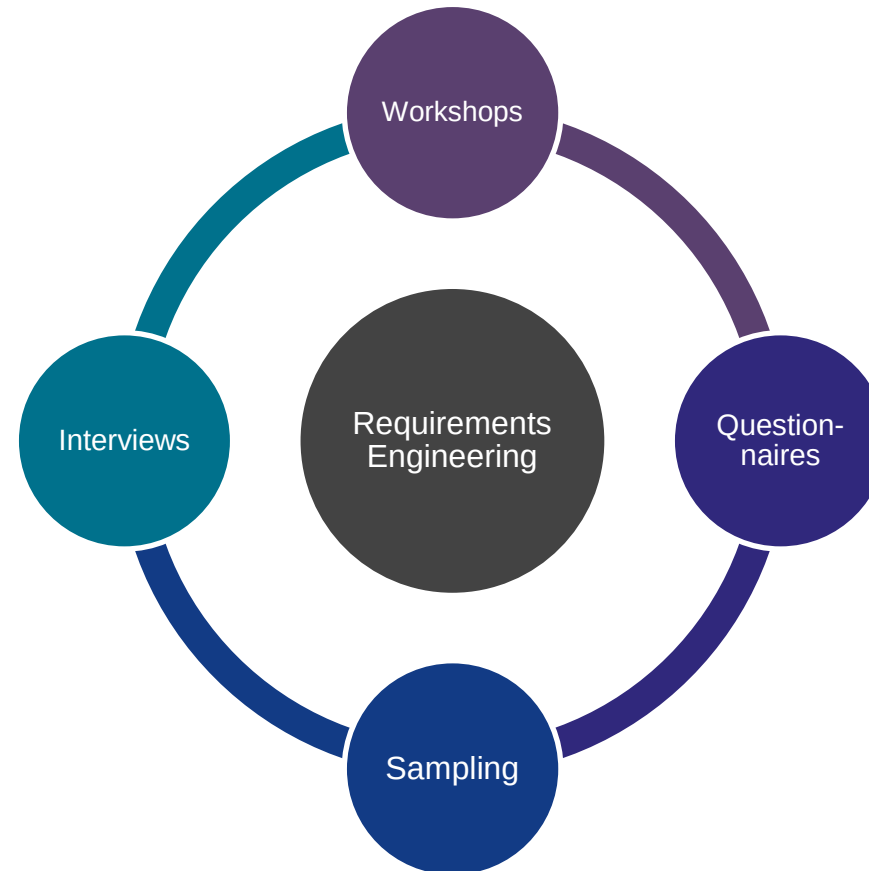
ICS-125 SENG Process Winter 2026

From Interviews to Requirements

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Information gathering methods

- The processes used may vary widely depending on the application domain, the people involved and the organization developing the requirements.



Steps in planning the interview

1. Read background material
2. Establish interviewing objectives
3. Decide whom to interview
4. Prepare the interviewee
5. Decide on question types and structure.

Stakeholder interview

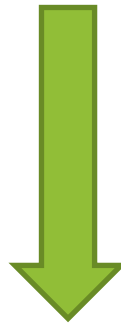
- Goal: Understand real needs.
- Ask about:
 - Daily tasks and current system problems: these identify the core Functional Requirements (FR) and the **Purpose** of the project.
 - Who will be using the system: this identifies your stakeholders and the “**Actors**” for your Use Cases.
 - Security, performance and usability: these translate directly into Non-Functional Requirements (NFR)
- Example: ‘How do students register for courses today?’

Extracting User Stories

- A **User Story** is a brief, informal explanation of a software feature written from the perspective of the end user. User stories act as the bridge between raw interview data and formal system requirements.
- Three pillars of a user story:
 - The Persona (who?): the specific type of user or stakeholder performing the action.
 - The Intent (what?): the goal or functional requirement the user wants the system to achieve.
 - The Value (why?): the underlying reason or benefit they receive from that action.
- Format:
 - *As a [role], I want [goal] so that [benefit].*

Example of User Stories

- Stakeholder during interview: “Right now, I have no clear way to see who has actually registered until the system updates at the end of the day. I need a way to view the list of registered students in real-time so I can manage the course capacity effectively.”



- User Story (US1): As an administrator, I want to view a list of all registered students so that I can monitor enrollment.

Identifying Functional Requirements

- Functional Requirements (FR) are directly extracted from User Stories.
- While a User Story describes a need from the user's perspective, the Functional Requirement translates that need into a specific technical behavior the system must perform.
- The **User Story** (The "**Why**" & "**What**"): States that a student wants to register for courses to enroll in classes.
- The **Functional Requirement** (The "**How**"): Breaks that story down into actionable system tasks, such as:

Example of FR

- Stakeholder during interview: “Right now, I have no clear way to see who has actually registered until the system updates at the end of the day. I need a way to view the list of registered students in real-time so I can manage the course capacity effectively.”



- User Story (US1): As an administrator, I want to view a list of all registered students so that I can monitor enrollment.



- **FR1**: The system shall display a list of available courses.
- **FR2**: The system shall allow the user to select and submit a registration request.
- **FR3**: The system shall prevent duplicate enrollment.

Identifying Non-Functional Requirements (NFR)

- Non-Functional Requirements (NFR) define the “**how well**” the system operates rather than “what” it does.
- While the User Story describes the goal, the NFR sets the standards for quality such as performance, security and usability.
- The most important rule in NFR, is to make them measurable. For example:
 - **Performance**: the response time should be under 2 seconds, the data must be updated within 30 seconds of change
 - **Security**: users should be authenticated via a password that is at least 8 characters long and include 1 special character, only 2 specific roles (admin and staff) can delete the student records.
 - **Usability**: new staff members should be able to process a registration after 30 minutes of training, 90% of the users should be able to register for a course on their first attempt without help.